

全国大学生英语竞赛样题(B 类)
National English Competition for College Students
(Type B – Sample)

(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (35 marks)

Section A (15 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **two** conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause.*

*Listen to each conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

Conversation One (5 marks)

1. What does Mia want Professor Smith to do?

- A. Provide some facts for her essay.
- B. Give her some advice on writing a paper.
- C. Narrow down the topic of her article.
- D. Modify the draft essay for her.

2. How many words is the article limited?

- A. 1,500. B. 500. C. 5,000. D. 50,000.

3. What core suggestions has the Professor given Mia?
- A. To keep her topic focused and support her opinions with facts.
 - B. To read extensively and collect as many references as possible.
 - C. To have discussions with employees and give them more freedom.
 - D. To check the statistics on the topic of women's rights movements.
4. How will Mia probably begin her essay?
- A. List women's rights to different parities.
 - B. Call for women's voting rights in her own country.
 - C. Quote women's percentage in the national legislature.
 - D. Discuss women's voting rights in Western democracies.
5. How might the professor help Mia after the discussion?
- A. Reading her final essay.
 - B. Examining her outline.
 - C. Proofreading her rough draft.
 - D. Revising her subtopics.

Conversation Two (10 marks)

6. What first inspired Martin's interest in travelling?
- A. A television film about Africa.
 - B. A close friend from Singapore.
 - C. Something he read as a child.
 - D. Living abroad in the 1960s.
7. Wildlife filming is _____ than it was in the early 1960s.
- A. more relaxed
 - B. more creative
 - C. more challenging
 - D. more organised
8. What does Martin do when he takes a holiday?
- A. He travels for a particular reason.
 - B. He lies on the beach for relaxing.

- C. He stays comfortably in a big hotel.
 - D. He spends the whole day swimming.
9. What did Martin think of the holiday-makers he saw in the Dominican Republic?
- A. They were a very interesting bunch of people.
 - B. They weren't making full use of the holiday they had.
 - C. They were exposing themselves to too much sunshine.
 - D. They should do more physical exercise.
10. What's Martin's opinion of tourism?
- A. It should be well managed.
 - B. It has been boosted by his team.
 - C. It should be further explored.
 - D. It becomes a model for other sectors.

Section B (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the four choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

11. How many people need food aid in Somalia?
- A. Two million.
 - B. Five million.
 - C. Nine million.
 - D. Fifteen thousand.
12. Why will the Spanish state broadcaster stop showing bullfighting?
- A. The broadcaster RTVE thinks bullfighting is cruel.
 - B. Bullfighting could cause anxiety among kids.
 - C. The wildlife conservation association is against bullfighting.
 - D. Children need to learn how to protect animals.

13. Why did many people fall into the river?
- A. A large herd of livestock went through the bridge.
 - B. An overnight heavy storm destroyed the footbridge.
 - C. Villagers crowded on the bridge to catch the eatable insects.
 - D. The bridge fell into disrepair many years ago.
14. In what way does pheromone work on the same species of plant or animal?
- A. It travels in the water.
 - B. It travels through the air.
 - C. It travels in the blood.
 - D. It travels in the plant cap.
15. What did Ban Ki-moon propose to stop the current tensions in the Middle East?
- A. Unconditional ceasefire.
 - B. International intervention.
 - C. A long-term peaceful agreement.
 - D. A negotiated two-state solution.

Section C (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **one** monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **no more than six words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

16. Why shouldn't people try to write everything down in a lecture?
17. What is the purpose of using abbreviations and symbols?
18. What does the speaker ask the students to be?
19. How will the lecturer repeat the important information?
20. What is the main topic of the monologue?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this section. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

21. Five minutes earlier, _____ we could have caught the last train.
A. but B. and C. or D. so
22. Harvey always thought of himself as an easy-going and _____ person, who put up with people's peculiarities.
A. helpful B. tolerant C. quarrelsome D. indifferent
23. Please bring me a ladder, and put it _____ the tree, not the wall.
A. in B. on C. by D. against
24. A larger part of human activity, particularly in relation to the environment, is _____ condition or events.
A. in favor of B. in excess of C. in contrast to D. in response to
25. "The Lake Poets" such as William Wordsworth, Samuel Coleridge and _____ were connected with the Lake District.
A. John Keats B. Lord Byron C. Robert Southey D. Percy Shelly
26. _____ had I bought the mobile phone, _____ I regretted spending so much money on it.
A. No sooner; than B. Not only; but C. After; that D. As soon as; and
27. "Radar" is a/an _____.
A. acronym B. blending C. coinage D. clipping
28. Oil paints are _____ they have become the most popular painter's colors.
A. so versatile and durable than B. so versatile and durable that
C. such versatile and durable as D. such versatile and durable that
29. We find it impossible to _____ with the latest safety regulations.
A. accord B. unify C. obey D. comply
30. _____ little money left, they decided to hold a meeting to discuss what to do.
A. There be B. There being C. Since there had D. Since there were
31. Many people are _____ airborne pollutants such as pollen. _____, scientific research has found out that pollen is nutritious for human beings.
A. allergic to; However B. dependent on; On the contrary
C. immune to; However D. vulnerable to; On the contrary

world, and yet we can almost always recognize our friends with a (36) _____ quick, superficial glance at a few square inches of face or distinguish one another with great accuracy by examination of a fingertip. Much of our individuality is genetic because each of us, (37) _____ for identical twins, has a combination of genes that is uniquely our own. Of course, there are environmental differences too, and these include not only physical factors, such as the effects of diet on growth and development, but also all of the social and cultural influences in our lives. It is often difficult to (38) _____ the genetic and environmental components of our physical and behavioral individuality. During the past 100 years or so, there have been heated (39) _____ between those who stress the importance of heredity and those who see environmental as the main influence. We mustn't doubt the importance of environmental influences on how we turn out, but as we learn more about human heredity, it has become clear that the genetic effects extend far beyond the obvious physical aspects of our bodies. Your genes establish your physical, intellectual, and (40) _____ possibilities. How these will be developed is determined by environmental influences.

Section B (5 marks)

*Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word, or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

He was a funny looking man with a cheerful face, good-natured and a great talker. He was described by his student, the great philosopher Plato, as "the best, most just and wisest man". Yet, this same man was (41) sent _____ to death for his beliefs.

The man was the Greek philosopher, Socrates, the most interesting and (42) _____ (influence) thinker in the fifth century. His dedication to careful reasoning transformed the entire enterprise. Since he sought genuine knowledge (43) _____ than

He was condemned for not believing in the recognized gods and for corrupting young people. The second charge stemmed from his (44) asso_____ with numerous young men who went to Athens from all over the civilized world to study with him.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

What do we know about honey? It's sweet and sticky, and it tastes great on bread and in hot drinks, and it's a pleasant alternative to sugar. However, there's a lot more to honey than meets the eye, and one day it may replace many of the items in our medicine cabinets.

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and opera singers have been known to use it to boost their energy and soothe their throats.

Today, as homeopathic medicine is becoming more popular, honey has been rediscovered as a natural remedy and is being used successfully to treat many ailments such as anaemia, arthritis, colds and stomach ulcers. It is particularly effective in the treatment of burns and wounds. Honey aerosol sprays have ever been used to treat chronic bronchitis.

The beauty industry has also recognised the natural benefits of honey and there are many cosmetic companies which use honey-based products. These include creams, lotions, soaps and face masks which claim to help heal blemishes, reduce the appearance of scars, moisturise the skin, soften wrinkles and make skin look younger and healthier. There are also a number of honey-based hair care products which claim to strengthen hair and make it softer, shinier and healthier.

(47) _____ Honey is sold in various forms as a remedy for sore throats, stomach ulcers and as a gentle, natural laxative.

(48) _____ Well, after many years of research, biochemists still can't say for certain. They have, however, managed to identify some of the healing properties in honey. Firstly, honey contains low levels of hydrogen peroxide, a chemical which kills bacteria. Secondly, it creates a moist environment when spread onto a wound which speeds up the natural healing process. Scientists have also found that certain types of honey act as antibiotics. In fact, honey is actually more effective than some of our current antibiotics because it works on certain microbes and bacteria that have developed a resistance to the current antibiotic treatment. (49) _____

For example, honey containing nectar from the Australian jelly bush and the New Zealand tea tree have been found to possess more medicinal properties than other varieties.

Medical researchers are still working on identifying the role that honey could play in future medical practices, but they all agree that we should not be using the honey in

our kitchen cupboards to treat ourselves. (50) _____ They also agree, unfortunately, that simply eating honey has minimal health benefits.

Questions 46 to 50

Choose from the sentences A to G the one which best fits each gap of 46 to 50. There are *two extra sentences* which you do not need to use.

- A. This is because many commercial brands of honey actually contain bacteria which could contaminate an open wound.

B. Honey and products containing honey have always been popular items in health food shops.

C. Researchers are not sure about how sweet honey is.

D. Doctors throughout history have appreciated the medicinal properties of honey.

E. Honey is used today as a natural remedy by many homeopaths.

F. What is it then that makes honey such an effective natural remedy?

G. However, researchers have also found some types of honey are more beneficial than others.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

It was seen as the mark of civilized eating, and distinguished well-fed French workers from the English, who wolf down prawn sandwiches at their desks. However, France's tradition of the three-course restaurant lunch is in danger of being killed off by the economic crisis. Around 3,000 traditional French restaurants, cafés and bars went bust in the first three months of 2021 and unions predict a further rush of closures as

people worry about making ends meet. The number of French restaurants going bankrupt rose by 25% from last year, and cafés forced to close were up by 56%.

Le Figaro's renowned restaurant critic, Francois Simon, said that French consumers' frugality had changed national eating habits and forced restaurant owners to the brink. Diners were now skipping the traditional aperitif, avoiding starters, drinking tap water, passing on wine and coffee and sharing puddings.

Even the city's smartest restaurants are getting impatient with smaller orders. In one restaurant near Paris' Gare de Lyon, he reported, two couples were asked to leave by a desperate restaurant owner because they would not order starters. The restaurant chain Hippopotamus is now running loyalty deals and special-offer hamburgers, which have become more popular than French steak dishes. Office workers are increasingly buying take-away baguettes and supermarket lunches.

Making ends meet with low salaries and rising food prices has become a national obsession as France's economy continues to be sluggish. Regular TV reports describe the desperation of people forced to eat cheap tinned vegetables or forage in bins at markets. The restaurant sector has seen the third highest number of bankruptcies in France this year, after the construction and building trades, according to the credit insurance group Euler Hermes SFAC.

This time French people spend on eating meals in restaurants has already gone down: in 1975, a lunch out took an average of one and a half hours. By 2005, this had fallen to 32 minutes. Danièle Deleval, the vice president of the UMIH restaurant and hotel union, said, "We're very worried. Since the start of the year, the number of restaurant customers has dropped, on average, 20%, and we're seeing no signs of improvement."

Jean Guillaume, owner of Le Bouquet brasserie on Boulevard Haussmann in Paris' smart 8th district, said, "Lunch customers used to order a main course, dessert, coffee and a bottle of wine. Now they're limiting themselves to a main course, tap water, and giving up the rest. Of 75 customers in this lunchtime, none had a bottle of wine. It's the

end of a tradition of lunching out and it looks like figures will stay this low for two to three years.” The nearby bakery, however, was busy selling take-away baguettes, with queues down the street at midday.

Restaurant and bar owners are reeling from a poor summer with fewer international tourists visiting Paris. And in Toulouse, café owners complained that customers would try to make one drink last as long as possible. Even in French holiday destinations, like Arcachon in the west or the Côte d’Azur in the south, restaurant owners said business was down by at least 10%.

Questions 51 to 55

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

51. What is causing the number of people dining in restaurants to decrease?
52. Which expression in paragraph 1 means “*having just enough money to buy the things you need*” ?
53. Why were the two couples ordered to leave a restaurant near Gare de Lyon?
54. Which two sectors saw more bankruptcies than the restaurant sector?
55. Why is the summer described as “poor” in the last paragraph?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 56 to 60 are based on the following passage.

One student skipped a class and then sent the professor an email message asking for copies of the teaching notes. Another didn’t like her grade and sent a petulant message to the professor. Another explained that she was late for a Monday class because she was recovering from a party. One professor received a message from a student, saying, “I’m not sure how to shop for school supplies. Should I buy a binder or a subject notebook? Please tell me what you recommend.”

At college and universities, email has made professors more approachable, but many say it has made them too accessible. They say that students seem to view them as available round the clock, and send a steady stream of email messages—from ten a week to ten after every class—that is too informal or simply inappropriate. Michael J. Kessler, a lecturer at Georgetown university, says, “the tone that some of them take in an email is pretty astounding. I need to know this and you need to tell me right now.” It’s a fine balance to accommodate what they need and at the same time maintain a level of legitimacy as an instructor. We are authorized to make demands on them, and not the other way round.

Professor Patricia Ewick of Clark university, Massachusetts, said ten students emailed her drafts of their papers days before they were due, seeking comments. Ewick says, “It’s all different levels of presumption. One is that I’ll be able to drop everything and read 250 pages two days before I’m going to get fifty of these.” Robert B. Ahdieh, an associate professor of law, said he had received emails with messages such as, “You’re covering the material too fast,” or “I don’t think we’re using what we read as much as we could in class,” or, “I think it would be helpful if you would summarize what we’ve covered at the end of a class in case we missed anything.”

While once professors expected deference, their expertise seems to have become just another service that students, as consumers, are buying. So students may have no fear of giving offence or imposing on the professor’s time. Many professors say they are uncertain how to react to these emails. For example, the professor who was asked about buying the notebook said she debated whether to tell the student that this was not a query that should be directed to her, but worried that, “Such a message could be pretty scary,” and decided not to response at all.

Most professors, however, emphasized that instant feedback is sometimes invaluable. One professor said that questions about a lecture or discussion could indicate “a blind spot”—something that a student obviously didn’t understand. Others

have probably hit on the best solution by making rules for email: telling students how quickly the professor will respond, how messages should be drafted and what type of messages they will answer. Meg Worley, an assistant professor of English, tells students that they must say thank you after receiving a professor's response to an email. "The less powerful person always has to write back," she said.

Questions 56 to 60

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using **no more than three words** for each blank.

In higher education, professors are now (56) _____ than they used to be because of email. The problem is that some students either write too many emails or write emails that are (57) _____ (too informal or stupid). Kessler says he doesn't like (58) _____ of the emails he receives. Ewick thinks that students these days expect too much, and seem to think their teachers have lots of free time. Ahdieh received criticisms of his classes by email. Professors are uncertain about how to respond to these emails. However, a lot of professors take (59) _____ as an extremely useful method. Some professors have solved the problem by (60) _____ about the email students send them.

Part V Translation (20 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Remember to write the answer on the answer sheet.

61. A new study outlines how insomniacs might make their condition even more tiresome: clock-watching [or time-monitoring behavior (TMB)]. It seems this can aggravate insomnia, increase frustration, and lead to higher use of sleeping aids. It's a sort of negative feedback loop, the researchers found. TMB worsens insomnia and its associated annoyances, leading to more clock-watching and so on.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Remember to write the answer on the answer sheet.

62. 在中国,上门服务(door-to-door)已经从一种奢侈服务转变为日常消费模式。消费者,尤其是年轻一代,越来越喜欢订购这类服务,从而催生了新的业务增长点。报告显示,2021年中国的上门服务市场超过了2万亿元,2016年到2021年的复合年增长率为64%。同时,上门服务还创造了新的就业机会。

Part VI Error Correction (10 marks)

There are 10 errors altogether in the following passage. The errors are: missing words, unnecessary words and wrong words. Please correct them as follows: for a missing word, mark its position with the symbol “^” and write it; for an unnecessary word, cross it out with the symbol “\”; for a wrong word, underline it and write the correct word. An example of how to correct the error is provided below. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

For example:

One of my favourite writers are Charlotte Brontë. She was born in the early is nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities ^ they have now. than She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took \ great pleasure in a walking on the moors near her home.

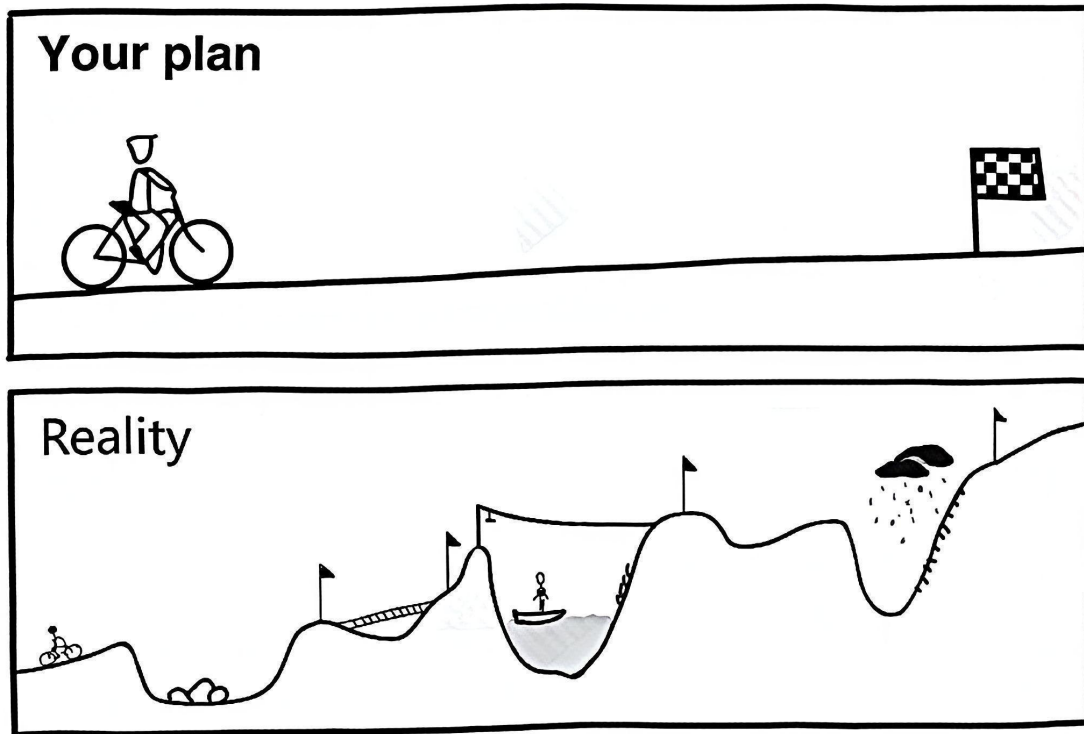
There is no doubt that the environment is in trouble. Factories burn fossil fuels where produce acid rain, and this kills trees. At the same time, greenhouse gases 63. _____ raise into the air and contribute to global warming, which threatens to melt the polar 64. _____ ice cap. Meanwhile, farmers clear huge areas of rain forest in places so as 65. _____ the Amazon to produce feeding land for cattle or produce wood for building. Rivers and oceans are so heavily contaminated by industrial waste. Cars pump out poisonous gases which we all have to breathe in. Poaching and overfish 66. _____ are killing off millions of animals, including whales, elephants and other endanger 67. _____ species. In fact, our finely balanced ecosystem is systematically destroyed 68. _____ by human greed and thoughtlessness.

There is a lot we can all do, however, to help prevent this. The easy thing, 69. _____ of course, is to recycle waste material such as paper and glass so that we can use it again. We should also check that the thing we buy from supermarket are packaged in biodegradable packaging which decompose easily. At the 70. _____ same time, we should make a conscious effort to avoid foods, which are genetically modified (at least until someone proves that they are safe both for us and for the environment). Finally, of course, a small car and unleaded petrol should be used, which are few harmful to the environment or, ever better, make 71. _____ more use of public transport. We cannot all be as committed as environmentalists, but we can at least do our own little bit with grass roots level. We, as humans, 72. _____ have inhabited the earth, but that doesn't mean we can do whatever we like with it.

Part VII Writing

Section A (10 marks)

73. Read the chart below about the comparison between idealism and reality, and write a report in **100–120 words** based on your own experience on the **answer sheet**.



Section B (20 marks)

74. Write about the following topic:

Is a professionally translated book or play just as good as the work in its original language? What are some advantages and disadvantages of reading a work in translation? *Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience. Write the essay in 140–180 words on the answer sheet.*